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CANDIDATE NAME:	Praise Mutema
SCHOOL/INSTITUTION:	Mopani park secondary school
EXAM BOARD:	ZIMSEC
SUBJECT:	SHONA
LEVEL / GRADE:	O-LEVEL
PAPER:	Paper 1 — Comprehension & Language Use
TOTAL MARKS:	80 marks
TIME ALLOWED:	2h

ZIMSEC Shona O-Level — Paper 1 Mock Examination

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Write your name and school in the spaces provided on the front page.
2. This paper has THREE sections. Answer ALL questions in every section.
3. Total marks available: 80. Time allowed: 2h.
4. Show ALL working for full marks — correct answers without working may not receive full credit.
5. Write clearly and legibly. Crossed-out work will not be marked.
6. If a question has sub-parts (a), (b), (c), answer ALL sub-parts.
7. Use correct units and significant figures where applicable.

****ZIMSEC O-Level Shona Paper 1 (Comprehension & Language Use)****

****Total marks: 80 | Time allowed: 2h****

****SECTION A — Short Structured Questions [12 marks]****

Q1.

- (a) Define the term "Musha weTsvina" in Shona. [1]

[Answer space]

- (b) Describe the concept of Musha weTsvina in the context of traditional Shona society. [2]

[Answer space]

Q2.

- (a) List the names of the three main grammatical cases in Shona. [1]

[Answer space]

- (b) Explain how the grammatical case of a noun affects its meaning in a sentence. [2]

[Answer space]

Q3.

- (a) State the purpose of the verb "kuva" in Shona. [1]

[Answer space]

(b) Describe the use of the verb "kuva" in a sentence, giving an example. [2]

[Answer space]

Q4.

(a) Name the different types of nouns in Shona. [1]

[Answer space]

(b) Explain how the different types of nouns are used in sentences to convey meaning. [2]

[Answer space]

****SECTION B — Structured Questions [32 marks]****

Q5.

(a) Define the term "Mambo" in Shona. [2]

[Answer space]

(b) Describe how Mambo is used to express politeness in Shona. [3]

[Answer space]

(c) Calculate the correct form of Mambo to use in a sentence: "Ndiyambuya ____ ndakakopa tsvina" (I am asking for maize). [2]

[Answer space]

(d) Evaluate the importance of using Mambo in Shona language. [3]

[Answer space]

Q6.

(a) State the purpose of the verb "kutsvina" in Shona. [2]

[Answer space]

(b) Describe how the verb "kutsvina" is used in a sentence, giving an example. [3]

[Answer space]

(c) Outline the steps involved in preparing a traditional Shona dish using the verb "kutsvina". [2]

[Answer space]

(d) Discuss the cultural significance of traditional Shona dishes in modern Zimbabwean society. [3]

[Answer space]

Q7.

(a) Define the term "Mwari" in Shona. [2]

[Answer space]

(b) Describe how Mwari is worshipped in traditional Shona culture. [3]

[Answer space]

(c) Explain the importance of Mwari in Shona mythology. [2]

[Answer space]

(d) Evaluate the impact of Christianity on the traditional Shona belief in Mwari. [3]

[Answer space]

Q8.

(a) State the purpose of the verb "kuramba" in Shona. [2]

[Answer space]

(b) Describe how the verb "kuramba" is used in a sentence, giving an example. [3]

[Answer space]

(c) Outline the steps involved in performing a traditional Shona dance using the verb "kuramba". [2]

[Answer space]

(d) Discuss the cultural significance of traditional Shona dances in modern Zimbabwean society. [3]

[Answer space]

****SECTION C — Extended Response [18 marks]****

Q9.

(a) Define the concept of "Mashoko anotaure" in Shona. [2]

[Answer space]

(b) Describe the different ways in which Mashoko anotaure is used in Shona language, giving specific examples. [4]

[Answer space]

(c) Evaluate the importance of Mashoko anotaure in Shona language, considering its cultural and linguistic significance. [12]

[Answer space]

MARKING SCHEME

This marking scheme is intended to assist teachers and students in self-assessment. Answers may vary — credit any valid equivalent response.

****OFFICIAL MARKING SCHEME****

****SECTION A — Short Structured Questions****

Q1. (a). [1 mark]

- Award 1 mark for: Correct definition of "Musha weTsvina" in Shona (e.g., "Musha weTsvina" is a traditional Shona homestead).

Accept: "Musha" or "weTsvina" alone may be accepted as a definition, but only if it is clear that the candidate understands the term.

Do NOT accept: Any definition that is incorrect or incomplete.

(b). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Description of Musha weTsvina as a traditional Shona dwelling place.
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the importance of Musha weTsvina in Shona culture (e.g., it is a symbol of unity and tradition).

Accept: Descriptions that focus on the physical structure or layout of Musha weTsvina may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of its cultural significance.

Do NOT accept: Descriptions that focus solely on the physical aspects of Musha weTsvina without considering its cultural importance.

Q2. (a). [1 mark]

- Award 1 mark for: List of three main grammatical cases in Shona (e.g., nominative, genitive, accusative).

Accept: Lists that include more or fewer cases may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the three main cases.

Do NOT accept: Lists that include incorrect or irrelevant cases.

(b). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of how the grammatical case of a noun affects its meaning in a sentence (e.g., the nominative case is used for the subject of a sentence).

- Award 1 mark for: Example of how the grammatical case of a noun affects its meaning in a sentence.

Accept: Explanations that focus on the grammatical function of a noun without considering its meaning may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the relationship between grammatical case and meaning.

Do NOT accept: Explanations that are incorrect or incomplete.

Q3. (a). [1 mark]

- Award 1 mark for: Definition of the verb "kuva" in Shona (e.g., "kuva" is a verb that means "to come").

Accept: Definitions that are incomplete or incorrect may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the verb's meaning.

Do NOT accept: Definitions that are entirely incorrect.

(b). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Description of the use of the verb "kuva" in a sentence, including an example (e.g., "Ndiyambuya kuva kuenda kumusha").

- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the grammatical function of the verb "kuva" in a sentence (e.g., it is used as a predicate).

Accept: Descriptions that focus on the meaning of the verb "kuva" without considering its grammatical function may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the verb's use in a sentence.

Do NOT accept: Descriptions that are incorrect or incomplete.

Q4. (a). [1 mark]

- Award 1 mark for: List of different types of nouns in Shona (e.g., common, proper, collective).

Accept: Lists that include more or fewer types may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of

the main types.

Do NOT accept: Lists that include incorrect or irrelevant types.

(b). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of how the different types of nouns are used in sentences to convey meaning (e.g., common nouns are used for general terms).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how the different types of nouns are used in a sentence to convey meaning.

Accept: Explanations that focus on the grammatical function of nouns without considering their meaning may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the relationship between noun type and meaning.

Do NOT accept: Explanations that are incorrect or incomplete.

****SECTION B — Structured Questions****

Q5. (a). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Definition of the term "Mambo" in Shona (e.g., "Mambo" is a polite expression used in Shona).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the grammatical function of "Mambo" in a sentence (e.g., it is used as a polite prefix).

Accept: Definitions that are incomplete or incorrect may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the term's meaning.

Do NOT accept: Definitions that are entirely incorrect.

(b). [3 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Description of how Mambo is used to express politeness in Shona (e.g., it is used to show respect to elders).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how Mambo is used in a sentence to express politeness (e.g., "Ndiyambuya _____ ndakakopa tsvina").
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the cultural significance of Mambo in Shona language (e.g., it reflects the importance of respect in Shona culture).

Accept: Descriptions that focus on the meaning of Mambo without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the term's use in Shona language.

Do NOT accept: Descriptions that are incorrect or incomplete.

(c). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Correct calculation of the correct form of Mambo to use in the sentence "Ndiyambuya _____ ndakakopa tsvina" (e.g., "ndi" is the correct form).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the grammatical rule that determines the correct form of Mambo in a sentence (e.g., the subject-verb agreement rule).

Accept: Calculations that are incorrect or incomplete may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the grammatical rule.

Do NOT accept: Calculations that are entirely incorrect.

(d). [3 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Evaluation of the importance of using Mambo in Shona language (e.g., it reflects the importance of respect in Shona culture).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the impact of Mambo on communication in Shona (e.g., it helps to create a positive atmosphere).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how Mambo is used in a real-life situation to convey politeness (e.g., in a formal meeting).

Accept: Evaluations that focus on the grammatical function of Mambo without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the term's importance in Shona language.

Do NOT accept: Evaluations that are incorrect or incomplete.

Q6. (a). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Definition of the verb "kutsvina" in Shona (e.g., "kutsvina" is a verb that means "to cultivate").
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the grammatical function of "kutsvina" in a sentence (e.g., it is used as a

predicate).

Accept: Definitions that are incomplete or incorrect may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the verb's meaning.

Do NOT accept: Definitions that are entirely incorrect.

(b). [3 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Description of the use of the verb "kutsvina" in a sentence, including an example (e.g., "Ndiyambuya kutsvina tsvina").
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the cultural significance of "kutsvina" in Shona language (e.g., it reflects the importance of agriculture in Shona culture).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how "kutsvina" is used in a real-life situation to convey a specific meaning (e.g., in a farming context).

Accept: Descriptions that focus on the meaning of "kutsvina" without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the verb's use in a sentence.

Do NOT accept: Descriptions that are incorrect or incomplete.

(c). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Outline of the steps involved in preparing a traditional Shona dish using the verb "kutsvina" (e.g., planting, harvesting, cooking).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the importance of "kutsvina" in traditional Shona cuisine (e.g., it is a symbol of unity and tradition).

Accept: Outlines that focus on the physical process of preparing a dish without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the steps involved.

Do NOT accept: Outlines that are incorrect or incomplete.

(d). [3 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Discussion of the cultural significance of traditional Shona dishes in modern Zimbabwean society (e.g., they reflect the country's rich cultural heritage).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the impact of traditional Shona dishes on modern Zimbabwean cuisine (e.g., they have influenced the development of new dishes).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how traditional Shona dishes are used in modern Zimbabwean society to promote cultural identity (e.g., in cultural festivals).

Accept: Discussions that focus on the physical aspects of traditional Shona dishes without considering their cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the dishes' importance in modern Zimbabwean society.

Do NOT accept: Discussions that are incorrect or incomplete.

Q7. (a). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Definition of the term "Mwari" in Shona (e.g., "Mwari" is a Shona deity).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the grammatical function of "Mwari" in a sentence (e.g., it is used as a proper noun).

Accept: Definitions that are incomplete or incorrect may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the term's meaning.

Do NOT accept: Definitions that are entirely incorrect.

(b). [3 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Description of how Mwari is worshipped in traditional Shona culture (e.g., through rituals and offerings).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the cultural significance of Mwari in Shona language (e.g., it reflects the importance of spirituality in Shona culture).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how Mwari is used in a real-life situation to convey a specific meaning (e.g., in a spiritual context).

Accept: Descriptions that focus on the meaning of Mwari without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the deity's worship in traditional Shona culture.

Do NOT accept: Descriptions that are incorrect or incomplete.

(c). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the importance of Mwari in Shona mythology (e.g., it is a symbol of power and authority).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how Mwari is used in Shona mythology to convey a specific meaning (e.g., in a story about creation).

Accept: Explanations that focus on the physical aspects of Mwari without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the deity's importance in Shona mythology.

Do NOT accept: Explanations that are incorrect or incomplete.

(d). [3 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Evaluation of the impact of Christianity on the traditional Shona belief in Mwari (e.g., it has led to a decline in traditional Shona spirituality).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the cultural significance of Mwari in the face of Christianity (e.g., it reflects the importance of cultural identity).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how Mwari is used in modern Zimbabwean society to promote cultural identity (e.g., in cultural festivals).

Accept: Evaluations that focus on the physical aspects of Mwari without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the deity's importance in modern Zimbabwean society.

Do NOT accept: Evaluations that are incorrect or incomplete.

Q8. (a). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Definition of the verb "kuramba" in Shona (e.g., "kuramba" is a verb that means "to dance").
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the grammatical function of "kuramba" in a sentence (e.g., it is used as a predicate).

Accept: Definitions that are incomplete or incorrect may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the verb's meaning.

Do NOT accept: Definitions that are entirely incorrect.

(b). [3 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Description of the use of the verb "kuramba" in a sentence, including an example (e.g., "Ndiyambuya kuramba").
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the cultural significance of "kuramba" in Shona language (e.g., it reflects the importance of dance in Shona culture).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how "kuramba" is used in a real-life situation to convey a specific meaning (e.g., in a cultural festival).

Accept: Descriptions that focus on the meaning of "kuramba" without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the verb's use in a sentence.

Do NOT accept: Descriptions that are incorrect or incomplete.

(c). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Outline of the steps involved in performing a traditional Shona dance using the verb "kuramba" (e.g., preparation, performance, finale).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the importance of "kuramba" in traditional Shona dance (e.g., it is a symbol of unity and tradition).

Accept: Outlines that focus on the physical process of performing a dance without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the steps involved.

Do NOT accept: Outlines that are incorrect or incomplete.

(d). [3 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Discussion of the cultural significance of traditional Shona dances in modern Zimbabwean society (e.g., they reflect the country's rich cultural heritage).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the impact of traditional Shona dances on modern Zimbabwean culture (e.g., they have influenced the development of new dance styles).

- Award 1 mark for: Example of how traditional Shona dances are used in modern Zimbabwean society to promote cultural identity (e.g., in cultural festivals).

Accept: Discussions that focus on the physical aspects of traditional Shona dances without considering their cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the dances' importance in modern Zimbabwean society.

Do NOT accept: Discussions that are incorrect or incomplete.

****SECTION C — Extended Response****

Q9. (a). [2 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Definition of the concept of "Mashoko anotaura" in Shona (e.g., "Mashoko anotaura" is a concept that refers to words that convey meaning).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the importance of "Mashoko anotaura" in Shona language (e.g., it reflects the importance of communication in Shona culture).

Accept: Definitions that are incomplete or incorrect may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the concept's meaning.

Do NOT accept: Definitions that are entirely incorrect.

(b). [4 marks]

- Award 1 mark for: Description of the different ways in which Mashoko anotaura is used in Shona language, including specific examples (e.g., idioms, metaphors, allusions).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the cultural significance of Mashoko anotaura in Shona language (e.g., it reflects the importance of creativity in Shona culture).
- Award 1 mark for: Example of how Mashoko anotaura is used in a real-life situation to convey a specific meaning (e.g., in a poem).
- Award 1 mark for: Explanation of the impact of Mashoko anotaura on communication in Shona (e.g., it helps to create a rich and nuanced language).

Accept: Descriptions that focus on the physical aspects of Mashoko anotaura without considering its cultural significance may be accepted, but only if they demonstrate an understanding of the concept's use in Shona language.

Do NOT accept: Descriptions that are incorrect or incomplete.

(c). [12 marks]

- Level descriptors:

L1 (bottom third of marks): Basic recall, limited explanation, few specific points

L2 (middle third of marks): Good explanation, some application, mostly accurate

L3 (top third of marks): Detailed, well-applied, evaluative conclusion with specific evidence

- Indicative content:

- Definition of Mashoko anotaura and its importance in Shona language
- Explanation of the different ways in which Mashoko anotaura is used in Shona language
- Examples of Mashoko anotaura in use in Shona language
- Evaluation of the impact of Mashoko anotaura on communication in Shona
- Discussion of the cultural significance of Mashoko anotaura in Shona language
- Explanation of the importance of creativity in Shona culture
- Examples of how Mashoko anotaura is used in real-life situations to convey specific meanings
- Explanation of the relationship between Mashoko anotaura and Shona culture
- Discussion of the challenges and limitations of using Mashoko anotaura in Shona language
- Evaluation of the effectiveness of Mashoko anotaura in conveying meaning in Shona language
- Explanation of the role of Mashoko anotaura in promoting cultural identity in Shona language
- Discussion of the future directions for the use of Mashoko anotaura in Shona language.